THE POSY ACADEMY

The Affiliate Creator Outreach Playbook

How to pitch brands, counter lowball offers, and land retainers -- using the numbers that actually matter.

a handpicked set of tools for creators who'd rather be living than working

by Brooke Co

THE FOUNDATION

You're not an influencer

Influencers get paid for reach. Affiliate creators get paid for sales. That distinction changes everything about how you pitch yourself to brands.

Most outreach templates floating around are built for influencers. They lead with follower count, engagement rate, and aesthetic. That's fine if you're selling ad space. But you're not -- you're driving revenue. Your outreach should prove it.

What brands actually care about (lead with these):

- Lifetime TikTok Shop GMV
- 30-day GMV
- Units sold (especially for specific products or categories)
- Conversion rate on affiliate videos
- Number of viral / high-converting videos
- Cross-platform distribution (TikTok auto-cross-posts to IG + FB)
- Live stream sales performance (revenue per stream)
- Repeat performance with similar products

What to stop mentioning (influencer metrics):

- Average live viewers
- Engagement rate
- Follower count
- Story views / reach / impressions
- "Brand alignment" fluff

TIP

If a brand asks for your engagement rate or follower count, that tells you they're used to working with influencers. Redirect the conversation to GMV and units sold. "I'd love to share my sales data instead -- that's a better indicator of what I can do for your brand."

BEFORE YOU PITCH

Know your numbers cold

Before you send a single outreach email, get clear on your own data. You should be able to answer all of these without looking anything up:

Your sales data:

- Lifetime TikTok Shop GMV
- Last 30-day GMV
- Top-selling product categories
- Standout brand results (units sold, GMV, timeframe)
- Best-performing video results

Your business terms:

- Per-video rate floor (the lowest you'll go)
- Volume discount structure (if you offer one)
- Preferred retainer length (1, 3, or 6 months)
- Live stream rate (separate from video rate)
- Payment terms (50% upfront, net 30, per-video on delivery)
- Content approval rounds (1 round standard, additional at $X)

Your boundaries:

- Categories you won't touch
- Ethical/values-based filters (clean ingredients, no animal testing, etc.)
- Brands you're already in retainers with (can't pitch competitors)
- Brands on your blocklist

TEMPLATE 1

Cold outreach

Cold outreach is for brands you've never worked with. The goal is simple: prove you can sell their type of product, and make it easy for them to say yes.

What to include:

- Lead with your GMV (lifetime + last 30 days)
- Mention adjacent product categories you've sold in
- Highlight cross-platform reach (TikTok auto-cross-posts to IG + FB)
- Mention Meta usage rights / Spark Ads availability
- Push for a 3-month retainer with discounted rates for commitment
- Use your actual rate -- never lowball yourself to get in the door
- End with a clear CTA: ask for their budget or a call

What NOT to include:

- Your follower count
- Your engagement rate
- "I love your brand" without sales data to back it up
- Long intros about who you are before getting to the numbers

TIP

Keep cold outreach under 200 words. Brands get hundreds of these. Lead with the number that matters most (GMV), make your ask clear, and get out. They can ask for more if they're interested.

TEMPLATE 2

Warm outreach

Warm outreach is for brands you've already made sales for but don't have a formal retainer with. This is your strongest pitch -- you have proof.

What to include:

- Lead with the specific GMV / units sold for THEIR product
- Reference the timeframe and standout video performance
- Pitch a formal retainer to scale what's already working
- Mention algorithm consistency benefits of ongoing content
- Suggest category exclusivity as optional leverage
- Rates should be higher here -- results are proven
- Ask for a call to discuss scaling the partnership

Before you write this email, know:

- The brand name
- Which products you sold
- Exact GMV / units for that brand
- The timeframe

Don't send warm outreach without these specifics. Vague results undercut your pitch.

TEMPLATE 3

Counter-offers

Brands will lowball you. It's not personal -- it's how negotiations work. But how you respond determines whether you get your rate or get stuck at theirs.

The first step is always the same: do the math out loud.

"$[their offer] / [number of videos] = $[per video rate]"

Then match your tone to how far off they are:

Tier 1: Mildly under (10-30% below your rate)

Polite, professional decline. State your floor, leave the door open. Note that Spark Ads and usage rights are priced separately.

Tier 2: Significantly under (50%+ below your rate)

Firmer tone. Do the math, state your floor clearly, and note that the offer reflects a misunderstanding of your tier as a creator. Example:

"I appreciate the offer, but $X/video isn't reflective of where I'm priced as a creator driving $[GMV] in monthly TikTok Shop sales. My floor is $[rate]/video, with discounted rates available for longer-term commitments."

Tier 3: Insulting offers (under $50/video or under 25% of your floor)

Pick your angle:

The "you're not ready" angle: Let them know their budget doesn't match creators at your level. Wish them well. Door stays open but you're not chasing.

The "I know my worth" angle: Acknowledge the gap, decline without apologizing, and invite them back when their budget shifts.

The "do your homework" angle: Point out that the offer is significantly below market for creators driving real GMV. Encourage them to benchmark before sending offers like that.

TIP

For ALL counter-offers, always include: the exact per-video math, your actual floor rate, a note that Spark Ads and usage rights are SEPARATE from the video rate, and either a door-open closer or a clean walkaway.

BEYOND THE VIDEO RATE

Optional add-ons

Your video rate is just the starting point. These are separate line items you can negotiate:

- Exclusivity clause (no competing brands during retainer period)
- Whitelisting / Spark Ads pricing (flat fee or rev share, separate from video rate)
- Live stream rate (separate from video retainer -- priced per stream)
- Cross-posting opt-in or opt-out
- Sample / product requirement before filming
- Content approval rounds (1 round standard, additional rounds at $X)
- Usage rights duration (90 days, 6 months, or perpetual -- each priced differently)
- Performance bonuses (bonus per X units sold)

Don't bundle these into your video rate. Every add-on that gets folded into the base rate is money left on the table. Price them separately so brands see the full value of what they're getting.

The bottom line

You drive sales. That's your leverage. Stop pitching like an influencer and start pitching like a revenue partner. Lead with GMV, know your floor, and never apologize for your rates. The brands that get it will pay them.

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